

The next thing I realized was that Angstrom Technologies couldn't be followed in the newspaper. That my company was too tenuous an enterprise for its stock price to appear in those long columns in the local business pages was deeply disturbing, and something I didn't want my wife to know. This inspired another phone call to Ms. Garrett. She said Angstrom might be found in the *Wall Street Journal* on certain days, and she was sure it was covered in the weekly *Barron's*.

After making a huge outlay for the stock, I refused to pay the \$1.75 a copy for the *Barron's* on the grounds that \$1.75 was an extravagance. One Sunday, I told my wife I was going out to pick up some orange juice. This was only an excuse to drive to a local grocery/newsstand and to thumb through the latest *Barron's* there. After thumbing for 20 minutes, I finally located Angstrom in a so-called Supplemental List of over-the-counter stocks. Two Sundays in a row, I went out for orange juice, and came back knowing the weekly closing price of my stock.

These were happy trips, since Angstrom was on a remarkable upward flight. I bought the stock on December 12, and three weeks later, just past Christmas, it had risen beyond $2\frac{1}{2}$ a share, making my \$10,143 into \$12,965. This \$2,500 was the easiest profit I'd ever made. The gain had been so quick that if the trend continued, I figured I'd be rich in six months. I even bought my family some nice Christmas presents, beyond my normal miserly offerings.

By now my family knew of my wonderful run of luck, and I got us all a subscription to *Barron's*, so we could enjoy looking up Angstrom at home together.

Did I say *luck*? At first I felt lucky, but only momentarily. Mostly, I felt skillful. My confidence in my investing ability soared with each uptick. That Angstrom was a winner, I told myself, had never been in doubt. Wasn't this a tangible proof that my cautious approach, all those hours of study in the library, had paid off? Surely it took a talented investor to cull through the duller opportunities, to sense the potential in this stock, and to jump courageously into full commitment—\$10,000 worth of eggs in one basket—at just the right moment. I also congratulated myself on holding out for Linda Garrett, who among dozens of potential stockbrokers had proven superior in every respect. My quibble